Window Services Crime Prevention Booklet

Provided for your safety by the U.S. Postal Inspection Service



UNITED STATES POSTAL SERVICE®

UNITED STATES POSTAL INSPECTION SERVICE

REMINDER

For any suspicious customer:

1. Get vehicle license number, if possible.
2. Write down his or her description.

Your name _____

Work location _____

Supplies:

- PS Form 8105-A, *Funds Transaction Report.*
- PS Form 8105-B, *Suspicious Transaction Report.*
- Publication 275, *Before, During, and After a Post Office Robbery.*

Police _____

Postal Inspector _____

Postal Police Officer _____

Supervisor _____

2. Emergency Phone Numbers

Bait Money Orders

1. Three per clerk with accountability.
2. Mix with large bills in cash drawer.
3. If you have a holdup camera, activate it.
4. Give bait money orders to robber in event of a robbery.

3. Bait Money Orders

Bulletproof Screenline — Oversized Parcels

1. Before accepting an oversized parcel, inspect it through the glass for proper addressing, packaging, etc.
2. Direct the customer to the lobby door where you will accept the parcel.
3. Have another person accompany you to the door.
4. Open only the small, upper-portion of the wicket door.
5. If the customer looks or acts suspicious, or if you are alone in the office, refer the customer to an office that can accept such parcels.

4. Oversized Parcels

Selling Money Orders

1. Be wary of purchases of low-value money orders.
2. If a customer seems suspicious, record the vehicle license number and customer description without placing yourself in danger, and contact Postal Inspectors.
3. Customers who buy $3,000 or more in money orders in one day must complete PS Form 8105-A, *Funds Transaction Report,* and show photo ID with name and address. The policy limiting the purchase of money orders to $10,000 per day has been rescinded.
4. Complete PS Form 8105-B, *Suspicious Transaction Report,* for suspicious activity, regardless of the amount or type of transaction. Suspicious activity may include frequent and large cash purchases of money orders or wire transfers.

5. Selling Money Orders

Cashing Money Orders

1. Have the customer sign money order in your presence.
2. Record a valid ID (valid state-issued driver's license or non-driver's ID, a foreign or domestic passport, military photo ID, or other U.S. government-issued ID with the customer's photo and signature). Refuse to cash a money order for anyone without an acceptable ID.
3. Compare the person with the ID photo and compare the signature on the money order with the ID signature.
4. Check the stolen money order list.
5. See page 16 of this brochure for instructions on checking for altered or counterfeit money orders.
6. If stolen, altered, or counterfeit, go to the next page.

6. Cashing Money Orders

What to Do With a Fraudulent Money Order

1. *Do not* return money order to customer.
2. Stall the customer (say you need change or make another excuse).
3. Notify your supervisor and Postal Inspector.
4. Call local police.
5. **Do not endanger yourself.** If threatened, call your supervisor.
6. Offer the customer a receipt for the money order if he or she wants to leave.
7. If you have a holdup camera, activate it.
8. Protect the money order from unnecessary handling by placing it in an envelope.
9. Write down the vehicle license number and description of the customer, if you can do so without risking your safety.

7. Stolen, Altered, Counterfeit Money Orders

Accepting Large Bills

1. Does president's face match denomination of bill? *If not,* go to next page.
2. Hold it next to a crisp $1 bill — does it lack fine detail or look suspicious?
3. *If suspicious:*
   a. You may decline to accept it due to "lack of change," or
   b. Stall the customer. Notify your supervisor.
      - If necessary, contact Postal Inspectors and advise them you suspect a bill is counterfeit.
      - If a Postal Inspector asks you for identifying marks, see "Security Features" on page 15 of this brochure.
      - If counterfeit, go to next page.

 Accepting Large Bills

Counterfeit or Altered Currency

1. *Do not* return bill to customer.
2. Stall customer (say you need change or make another excuse).
3. Call Postal Inspectors and supervisor.
4. *Do not endanger yourself.* If the customer threatens you, call your supervisor.
5. Offer a receipt for bill if customer wants to leave.
6. If you have a holdup camera, activate it.
7. Protect bill from unnecessary handling by placing it in an envelope.
8. Get vehicle license number and describe customer.

9. Phony or Altered Currency

Assault Prevention

1. Don’t argue with customers. Attempt to diffuse difficult situations.
2. Report any problems to your supervisor.
3. Don’t expect that wearing a uniform, or the fact that you are a government employee, will protect you from assaults.

Burglary

1. If you are the first to arrive and there is evidence of a burglary, *do not go into the Post Office.*
2. Call police, Postal Inspectors, and your supervisor.
3. Remain a safe distance away but close enough to observe the entrance.
4. If you are inside when you discover a burglary, call the police and Postal Inspectors, then wait outside.
5. Let police and Postal Inspectors conduct search, then protect the crime scene. Close the office/window service, if necessary. *Do not touch anything!*
6. If you witness the burglary, get the vehicle license number and description of burglars if you can do so without risking your safety.

Robbery Prevention

1. Be alert for trouble in the parking lot, around entries and exits, and in the Post Office lobby.
2. Report suspicious activity to your supervisor, who will notify police and Postal Inspectors.
3. Don't retain excess cash in the office or carry large amounts of personal cash.
4. Never leave cash, blank money orders, or stamp stock within reach of customers or in plain view.
5. Lock your cash drawer when away from the window.
6. Be alert to what's happening around you — in the lobby or at the next window.
7. Keep all exterior doors with access to work areas locked.
8. Question unknown personnel in mail-handling areas.
9. Don't discuss money or valuable mail on hand, transportation, or details of the security system with employees or nonemployees who don't need to know.
10. Don't count cash in view of the public.

Actions During a Robbery

1. Take no action that will jeopardize your personal safety.
2. If a robber displays a firearm, consider it loaded and assume he or she is willing to use it.
3. Don't panic, stay calm, and do exactly as you are told.
4. Activate your holdup camera if you can do so without drawing attention.
5. If the robber has written a note, place it aside and attempt to retain it as evidence.
6. Warn the robber of any surprises such as entering customers or returning employees.
7. Without being obvious, observe the robber and his or her actions. Form a clear picture of the robber in your mind — features, voice, clothes, manner, and direction of escape.

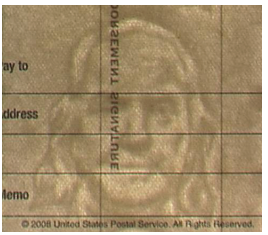
What to Do After a Robbery

1. Call police immediately. If possible, provide detailed description of robber, type of weapon, vehicle used, type of vehicle, and license number, direction of getaway, and exact time of robber's departure.
2. Call Postal Inspectors and your supervisor.
3. Do not turn off holdup camera until it has used all of the film/video or until you are directed to do so.
4. Ask witnesses and employees to remain. If they must leave, get their names, addresses, and phone numbers.
5. Protect the crime scene. Close the office, if necessary. Don't touch anything, and keep others away.
6. *Do not* compare notes with others until you have given your information to Postal Inspectors and police.
7. Write the vehicle license number and a description of robber in Publication 275 (or on any note paper).

Security Features for $20 Bills

Money Order Security Features

Be sure to check for these features before you accept or cash a postal money order:

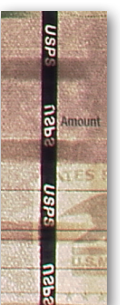


1. When held to the light, a repeating watermark of Benjamin Franklin appears on the left and runs from top to bottom.

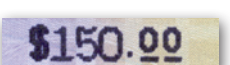
2. To the right of the watermark is a vertical, multicolored thread that weaves in and out of the paper. When held to the light, the thread appears continuous, with alternating horizontal dark and light bars behind it. The letters "USPS" repeat backward and forward throughout the thread.



Front-lit



Back-lit



POS



PMO

3. There should be no discoloration around the dollar amounts (which could indicate the amounts were changed).

Domestic postal money orders may not exceed $1,000, and international postal money orders may not exceed $700.

Accountables Entrusted to You

Accountables entrusted to you are the property of the Postal Service. All personal use of funds or postage are strictly prohibited.

1. Do not cash personal checks through your accountability.
2. If you need stamps, money orders, or other services, notify your supervisor or make purchases from other window clerks with your supervisor's approval.
3. Do not become careless or develop a lax attitude toward Postal Service funds.

Remember, anything entrusted to you or coming into your possession as a result of your official employment is the property of the U.S. Postal Service.

17. Employee Embezzlement

To order this publication, call 1-800-273-1509.

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